# MACCHERONCINI DI CAMPOFILONE AL SUGO TRADIZIONALE

| REGION | SERVES | TOTAL TIME |
|---|---|---|
| **Central** | **4-6** | **5 h plus the dough rest** |

## INGREDIENTS

| | |
|---|---|
| **454 g** | Beef short ribs, cut into 3-inch pieces |
| **quantity not given** | Salt |
| **150 g** | Celery |
| **150 g** | Carrot, peeled |
| **370 g** | Onion |
| **112 g** | Olive oil |
| **25 g** | Garlic, finely chopped |
| **1** | Whole clove |
| **220 g** | Dry white wine |
| **227 g** | Beef marrowbone |
| **680 g** | Tomato passata |
| **quantity not given** | Nutmeg, for the sugo |
| **1 batch** | Egg dough |
| **22 g** | Parmigiano-reggiano, finely grated |
| **quantity not given** | Nutmeg, to finish |

## METHOD

1. Salt the short ribs on every side and leave them at room temperature for at least an hour, or refrigerate them overnight.
2. Fit a meat grinder with the small die. Cut the celery, carrot and onion into pieces of ½ to 1 inch, then pass them all through the grinder. Gather the ground vegetables in cheesecloth and wring the excess liquid out. That is your soffritto.
3. Heat the oven to 275°F.
4. Pour 56 g of the olive oil into a large heavy pot or Dutch oven and set it over high heat. Sear the short ribs golden brown on every side, 3 to 4 minutes a side and 10 to 15 minutes all told.
5. Move the ribs to a plate. Pour off and discard whatever oil is left in the pot.
6. Wipe the pot out and set it over medium-low heat. Add the remaining 56 g olive oil and the soffritto and cook, stirring often, until softened but with no color, 5 to 8 minutes. Stir the garlic in for 10 to 15 seconds, again without letting it color.
7. Stud one short rib with the clove and return all the ribs to the pot. Pour in the wine and simmer until it has halved, 5 to 7 minutes.
8. Add the marrowbone, then the passata, then enough water to sit about ½ inch proud of the meat. Grate nutmeg in with a light hand, since it blooms as the sauce cooks.
9. Cover the pot and braise in the oven 3 to 4 hours, until the meat falls off the bone. Take it out and let it cool.
10. Lift the cooled ribs out and pull the meat off the bones. Shred it into fine strands with two forks and pick out the sinew. Go over the strands with a knife to cut them very fine. Push the marrow out of the marrowbone with a spoon handle, keeping the white part and throwing away the brown bits and the bone.
11. Skim the excess fat off the top of the sauce, leaving a little behind for flavor. Stir the meat and marrow back in. Cut fine enough, the meat all but disappears into the sauce.
12. Measure out 462 g of the sugo for this dish. The remainder keeps 3 days in an airtight container in the fridge, or a month in the freezer.
13. Make 624 g of maccheroncini di Campofilone from the egg dough.
14. Salt a large pot of water generously and bring it to the boil.
15. Set a large saute pan over low heat with the measured sugo and 1 to 2 ladles of pasta water, 55 to 115 g, to thin it slightly.
16. Shake the maccheroncini gently so the strands separate. Drop them into the water and stir straight away so they do not clump. They need about 30 seconds. The strands are very delicate and cook in a flash.
17. Transfer the pasta to the saute pan with tongs or a pasta basket and raise the heat to medium. Toss gently for 30 seconds to 1 minute to marry. A spoon keeps the strands moving more kindly than tongs do. Loosen with a splash of pasta water if the sauce feels tight. It is married when it clings with a glossy sheen.

18. Divide into bowls and finish with the parmigiano and a grating of nutmeg.

## NOTES

South of Emilia-Romagna the ragù carries less meat and more tomato, so what you get is a sauce the meat flavors rather than one the meat stars in.
One marrowbone and the short ribs do all the flavoring. The meat returns to the pot chopped so fine it reads as texture rather than as pieces of beef.
Nutmeg blooms over a three- to four-hour braise, so go light at the start. A second grating goes over the finished plates.
The sugo makes well over the 462 g the dish needs. Hold the rest back for another use.
The pasta is finished with a spoon rather than tongs because the strands are thin enough to tear.

SHAPE

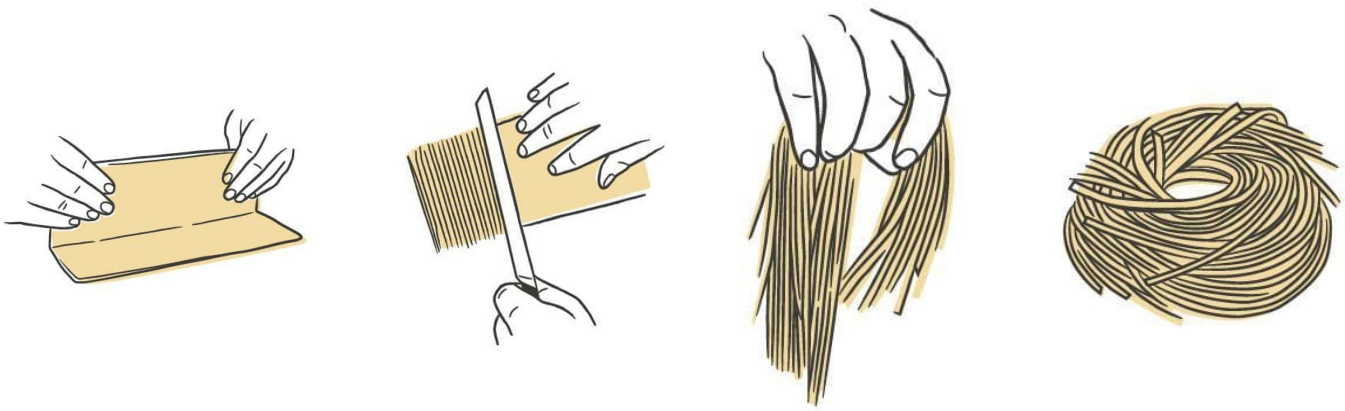
## Maccheroncini di Campofilone

*Region: The Marche, province of Fermo, around Ascoli Piceno and Campofilone / Rest: 20-30 min at room temperature*

### METHOD

1. Make an egg-based dough, then roll and sheet it.
2. Give a wooden work surface a light dusting of 00 flour. Line a sheet pan with parchment, then dust the parchment with semolina.
3. Knife the sheets into 18-inch lengths and trim the ragged edges off. Save the trim for soup. Keep the sheets under plastic or a towel.
4. Fold one sheet in half, then in thirds, until you have a packet about 4 1/2 by 6 inches. Turn it so the long side faces you and trim the ends. Cut 1/10-inch strands, working inward from one edge.
5. Dust the strands heavily with 00 flour and shake them apart. Coil the batch into a nest on the pan.
6. Repeat with the rest of the sheets.
7. Dry 20 to 30 minutes at room temperature.
8. To hold, cover the pan with plastic and refrigerate up to 24 hours.

### SHAPING



1 2 3 4

### NOTES

Cut width is 1/10 inch, by hand off a folded packet. No cutter attachment.
The book also describes the shape as often under 1 mm wide, which is thinner than the 1/10 inch the cutting step specifies. Treat 1/10 inch as the working figure.
Thinner than tagliolini, which is itself a thinner tagliatelle. Same family as tajarin.
Cooks very fast and goes to mush if it sits. Sauce it immediately.
Coiled into a nest, not spread flat.
Refrigerated shelf life is 24 hours.
Traditional pairings are a beef-spiked red sauce or a fish ragu. Robbins prefers the meat version.

DOUGH

# Egg Dough

*Makes: 954 g / Active Time: 8-10 min kneading / Rest: 30 min minimum, wrapped*

**INGREDIENTS**

| | |
|---|---|
| **500 g** | Tipo 00 flour |
| **454 g** | Egg yolks |
| **as needed** | Extra 00 flour for kneading |
| **up to 1 tbsp, only if dry** | Room-temperature water |

**METHOD**

1. Mix the yolks lightly, without beating them.
2. Mound the flour on a wooden surface and open a well 5 to 6 inches across. Wider than that and the walls collapse.
3. Add half the yolks, drawing in flour from the inner wall with a fork, working round the circumference.
4. Add the rest the same way. If the wall breaks, scrape the escape back into the flour until the mass holds itself.
5. Knead 8 to 10 minutes: press down and away with the heel of your hand, rotate 180 degrees, fold, repeat. Scrape your hands and the board as you go.
6. Add water a tablespoon at a time only if it stays dry and refuses to come together.
7. Stop when it is smooth, firm, and springs back slightly when poked. The texture to aim for is Play-Doh.
8. Wrap and rest at least 30 minutes before rolling.

**NOTES**

454 g of yolks is roughly 24 to 26 eggs, so plan what the whites are for.
Yolks only, no whites and no whole eggs, which is what makes this rich and tender rather than elastic.
Dry winter air is the usual reason it will not come together. Flour the board sparingly, since excess dries it out.
Keeps 24 hours. Chilled overnight, pull it out 20 minutes before rolling.

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DATE ____ / ____ / ____ RATING ____ / 5 OVEN ADJ _____

NOTES _____

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